Almayrah Abbas Tiburon

Almayrah Abbas Tiburon, PhD, is a Meranaw writer, educator, literary editor, and cultural advocate whose creative and scholarly work has significantly shaped the documentation and representation of Meranaw identity, history, and lived experience within Philippine and Bangsamoro literature. Based in Marawi City, she serves as Director of the MSU-Sentro ng Wika at Kultura and faculty member at the Department of Filipino and Other Languages, Mindanao State University–Marawi, where she advances language, culture, and literary scholarship in the Bangsamoro region.

Her body of work centers on the rich cultural traditions, historical consciousness, and socio-political realities of the Meranaw people, particularly exploring themes of women's experiences, war, displacement, motherhood, and identity in contexts such as the Marawi siege and contemporary Bangsamoro life. Through sustained creative output and editorial work, she has helped expand the visibility of Meranaw narratives in national and international literary spaces, establishing herself as one of the key contemporary voices in Meranaw and Bangsamoro literature.

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Background and Cultural Identity

Dr. Tiburon is a Meranaw cultural worker deeply rooted in Marawi City and the broader Lanao del Sur region. Her work consistently foregrounds Meranaw cultural heritage, weaving oral traditions, historical memory, and contemporary lived experiences into written literary forms. She bridges the gap between traditional Meranaw storytelling and modern Philippine literary expression, contributing to the preservation and evolution of Bangsamoro literary heritage. As a member of the Meranaw ethnic community, she has dedicated her career to documenting and amplifying the voices, narratives, and cultural perspectives that have historically been underrepresented in mainstream Philippine literature. Her creative and scholarly work serves as both artistic expression and cultural advocacy, ensuring that Meranaw stories, languages, and worldviews remain vibrant and accessible to present and future generations.

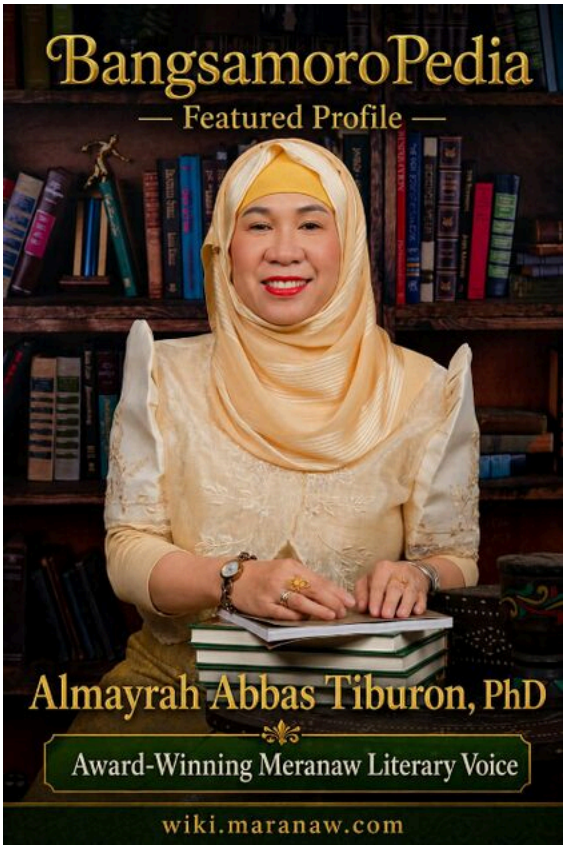
Education

Dr. Tiburon holds a PhD from Mindanao State University, where she has also built her academic career. Her scholarly training and research interests focus on Philippine literature, Meranaw studies, Bangsamoro literary traditions, creative writing, and cultural heritage documentation. Her academic background informs her approach to literary production, blending rigorous scholarly inquiry with creative expression to produce works that are both artistically compelling and culturally grounded.

Literary Career and Major Works

Dr. Tiburon is the author of several significant literary works that have garnered national recognition and critical acclaim. Her published books include *Terminal* and *Terminal 2* (also available in e-book format), *Thotholan: Mga Alamat at Pabulang Meranaw* (a collection of Meranaw legends and fables), *Salamin at Iba Pang Panglaw*, and *Mga Danas*. These works explore complex themes including Meranaw identity, cultural memory, gender, war, motherhood, and the lived experiences of communities in the Bangsamoro region, particularly in the aftermath of conflict and displacement. Her creative output spans multiple genres, including short fiction, poetry, and essays. She has published extensively in major national and international literary platforms and anthologies, establishing a presence in both Philippine and global literary communities. Her works have appeared in publications by Isang Balangay Media Productions, Gantala Press anthologies (including *Danas*, *Lawanen 1 & 2*, and *Umaalma*), Cultural Center of the Philippines literary journals (*Ani 40* and *In Certain Seasons*), University of the Philippines Press publications (*Likhaan Journal*, *BioLente* anthology, COVID-era anthologies), Far Eastern University anthology (*Mindanao Harvest 4*), Xavier University anthology (*Songs Sprung from Native Soils*), *Liwayway Magazine*, and the *Bangsamoro Literary Review* (Issues 1, 6-11). Her works have also achieved international circulation through translation into English and other languages including Japanese and Vietnamese. Her translated works have appeared in respected international literary platforms such as *Asymptote Journal*, *Keyboard and Breastfeed*, and *YUMO* (Japan Foundation), bringing Meranaw narratives to global audiences and contributing to cross-cultural literary exchange. Through her creative practice, she consistently centers the experiences of Meranaw women, the impacts of armed conflict on civilian communities, and the processes of cultural preservation and identity formation in contexts of displacement and social change. Her literary voice provides nuanced, intimate portrayals of life in Marawi and the

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Born	Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Occupation	Writer, Educator, Editor, Cultural Advocate
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Meranaw
Genre	Creative Writing, Short Fiction, Poetry, Essay, Literary Translation
Notable works	*Terminal*, *Terminal 2*, *Thotholan: Mga Alamat at Pabulang Meranaw*, *Salamin at Iba Pang Panglaw*, *Mga Danas*
Notable awards	National Book Awards Finalist (2019), Filipino Readers' Choice Awards Finalist, Gawad Ongangen (MSU-CSSH), Kampeon ng Wika (2024)
Academic background	PhD, Mindanao State University
Current position	Director, MSU-Sentro ng Wika at Kultura; Faculty, Department of Filipino and Other Languages, MSU-Marawi

broader Bangsamoro region, offering readers insight into a community whose stories have often been marginalized or oversimplified in dominant narratives.

Editorial Contributions

Beyond her work as a creative writer, Dr. Tiburon has made significant contributions as a literary editor, helping to curate and preserve important collections of Meranaw and Bangsamoro narratives. She served as editor for *Lawanen 2: Mga Alaala ng Pagkubkob*, a critical anthology documenting memories and testimonies of the Marawi siege, and edited the Marawi section of *Ani 40: Katutubo*, published by the Cultural Center of the Philippines. These editorial projects reflect her commitment to creating spaces for marginalized voices and ensuring that collective memories of conflict, resilience, and cultural continuity are documented and made accessible to wider audiences. Her editorial work demonstrates both curatorial skill and cultural responsibility, as she navigates the sensitive task of presenting narratives of trauma, displacement, and recovery while honoring the dignity and agency of those whose stories are being shared. Through these anthologies, she has helped create literary archives that serve as both historical documentation and vehicles for healing and cultural affirmation.

Recognition and Awards

Dr. Tiburon's literary contributions have been recognized through multiple prestigious awards and critical acknowledgments. She was a finalist for the National Book Awards in 2019 and the Filipino Readers' Choice Awards, and her work was included in CNN Philippines' "Best Books of the Decade" listing. She is a recipient of the Gawad Ongangen from MSU College of Social Sciences and Humanities and was honored with the national award Kampeon ng Wika 2024 by the Komisyon sa Wikang Filipino, recognizing her contributions to the advancement and preservation of Philippine languages and literatures. She has also been recognized as one of the "10 Noteworthy Filipina Writers" by Spot.ph, highlighting her influence in contemporary Philippine literary culture. Her works have been included in significant national anthologies on war, memory, gender, pandemic literature, and Bangsamoro writing, cementing her position as a crucial voice in documenting and interpreting the Bangsamoro experience in contemporary Philippine literature.

Institutional Contributions and Cultural Leadership

Dr. Tiburon currently serves as Director of the MSU-Sentro ng Wika at Kultura in Marawi City, a role that positions her as a leader in the preservation, promotion, and development of Meranaw language and cultural heritage. Through this institutional platform, she works to strengthen cultural documentation efforts, support emerging writers and cultural workers, and create spaces for the transmission of Meranaw knowledge systems and artistic traditions. As a faculty member at the Department of Filipino and Other Languages at Mindanao State University–Marawi, she contributes to the education and formation of the next generation of Filipino and Bangsamoro writers, scholars, and cultural advocates. Her teaching and mentorship work helps ensure the continuity of literary and cultural production in the region, fostering environments where students can develop their own voices while remaining grounded in their cultural identities and histories. Her institutional roles reflect a holistic approach to cultural work that integrates creative practice, scholarly inquiry, community engagement, and institutional leadership. Through these multiple dimensions of engagement, she contributes to the strengthening of cultural infrastructure in the Bangsamoro region and the broader Mindanao context.

Legacy and Impact

Through her sustained creative, scholarly, and editorial work, Dr. Almayrah Abbas Tiburon has become one of the key contemporary voices in Meranaw literature and a significant figure in Bangsamoro literary culture. Her contributions extend beyond individual artistic achievement to include the creation of literary archives, the mentorship of emerging writers, and the strengthening of institutional support for language and cultural preservation in the Bangsamoro region. Her work bridges oral tradition, written literature, and cultural memory while contributing to the broader Bangsamoro narrative in Philippine literature. By centering Meranaw perspectives and experiences in her creative and editorial work, she challenges dominant narratives that have historically marginalized or misrepresented Bangsamoro communities. Her literary voice offers nuanced, culturally grounded portrayals of Meranaw life that resist simplification and assert the complexity, dignity, and resilience of her community. As both a creative artist and cultural advocate, she demonstrates how literature can serve as a form of cultural preservation, historical documentation, and social commentary. Her body of work provides future generations with access to Meranaw stories, languages, and perspectives, ensuring that these cultural resources remain alive and available for ongoing interpretation and engagement.

Selected Publications

Books

- *Terminal* (Isang Balangay Media Productions)
- *Terminal 2* (Isang Balangay Media Productions, also available in e-book format)
- *Thotholan: Mga Alamat at Pabulang Meranaw* (MSU-Meranaw Cultural Heritage Center Press)
- *Salamin at Iba Pang Panglaw* (Isang Balangay Media Productions)
- *Mga Danas* (MSU-Meranaw Cultural Heritage Center Press)

Anthology Contributions

- *Danas* (Gantala Press)
- *Lawanen 1 & 2* (Gantala Press)
- *Umaalma* (Gantala Press)
- *Kumikibo* (Gantala Press)
- *Ani 40: Katutubo* (Cultural Center of the Philippines)
- *In Certain Seasons* (Cultural Center of the Philippines)
- *Likhaan Journal - Dx Machina 3* (University of the Philippines Press)
- *BioLente* anthology (University of the Philippines Press)
- *Mindanao Harvest 4* (Far Eastern University)
- *Songs Sprung from Native Soils: More Conversations with Eight Mindanao Writers* (Xavier University Press)
- *Liwayway Magazine* (various issues)
- *Bangsamoro Literary Review* (Issues 1, 6-11)

International Publications

- *Asymptote Journal*
- *Keyboard and Breastfeed*
- *YUMO* (Japan Foundation)

Editorial Work

- *Lawanen 2: Mga Alaala ng Pagkubkob* (editor)
- *Ani 40: Katutubo* – Marawi section (editor)

References

External Links

- Mustaqim Philippines - Coverage on Noteworthy Filipina Writers (https://mustaqim.com.ph)
- Spot.ph - 10 Noteworthy Filipina Writers and Their Must-Read Works (https://www.spot.ph/culture)

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